

THE NEW LAUNCH PRICING

How Savvy Singapore Buyers Enter the
Same New Launch at a Better Price

The Simple Framework That Makes It Possible



DARREN KHEW

The New Launch Pricing Method

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CONTENTS

Introduction

What Nobody Tells You Before You Walk Into a Showflat

Chapter One

The Same Project, Two Very Different Prices

Chapter Two

How Developers Actually Price a New Launch

Chapter Three

The Three Windows

Chapter Four

Why Most Buyers Pay More Than They Need To

Chapter Five

How to Apply the Framework in 2026

INTRODUCTION

What Nobody Tells You Before You Walk Into a Showflat

I want to start with something that most people in my industry rarely say out loud. The Singapore new launch market is not a level playing field, and it never has been. That is not a criticism. It is simply the reality of how the system works, and once you understand it, everything about the way developers price and sell their projects begins to make sense in a completely different way.

My name is Darren Khew, and I have spent my career as a real estate agent working with buyers across Singapore's private property market. Over the years, I have sat with hundreds of people in showflats, walked through floor plans, discussed payment schedules and financial structuring, and helped families make one of the most significant purchasing decisions of their lives. What I have observed consistently is this: two buyers entering the same new launch project can end up paying meaningfully different prices for comparable units, and in most cases, the buyer who pays more has no idea that the other price ever existed.

When I share this with people for the first time, the reaction is almost always the same. They assume I am talking about

negotiation. They picture someone haggling with a developer's salesperson, or calling in a favour, or somehow gaming the system in a way that is not available to the average buyer. But that is not what I mean at all. The price variation I am describing is not hidden, and it is not the result of personal connections or insider dealings. It is built into the architecture of how new launches are priced, released, and sold in Singapore. It is a structural feature of the market, not an exception to it. And the buyers who benefit from it are simply the ones who took the time to understand how the system works before they walked through the showflat doors.

That understanding is what this book is about.

I want to be honest about what you will and will not find here. You will not find promises of miraculous discounts or suggestions that Singapore's property market is somehow broken or ripe for exploitation. It is not. The market is robust, well regulated, and in 2026, prices across the private residential sector remain firm and broadly upward trending. This is not a book about finding cheap property. It is a book about understanding pricing well enough to enter the right project at the right moment in its sales cycle, which in practical terms can mean a difference of tens of thousands of dollars on the same unit within the same development. For larger units at higher price points, that difference can climb considerably higher. And crucially, it is a difference that requires no compromise on the quality of the project, the location, or the unit itself.

What I have laid out across these pages is a framework I have built from years of working closely with buyers, studying how developers structure their releases, and paying close attention to the mechanisms that most buyers overlook because no one thought to

explain them. I wrote this not as an academic exercise, but because I genuinely believe that an informed buyer is a better buyer, and a better buyer makes decisions with clarity rather than anxiety. The property market can feel overwhelming, particularly for first time private property buyers or those upgrading from an HDB flat. There is a great deal of information available, and much of it is either too technical, too superficial, or too clearly written by someone trying to sell you something. My aim here is different. I want you to finish reading this and feel like you actually understand what is happening in the market and why, so that when the time comes to make your decision, you are making it from a position of knowledge rather than pressure.

A few things worth noting before we get into the substance. Everything covered in this book reflects the current Singapore market as it stands in 2025 and 2026, including actual PSF benchmarks across the three regions, the regulatory environment governing developers, and the documented mechanics of how pricing moves across a project's sales cycle. I have deliberately avoided vague generalisations. Where figures are given, they are grounded in what the market is actually doing. And where there is genuine nuance, I have tried to present it honestly rather than flattening it into a simpler but less accurate picture.

If you are thinking about buying a new launch in Singapore, whether for your own home or as an investment, the pages that follow will give you a framework that most buyers simply do not have. That framework does not guarantee any particular outcome. But it changes the way you see the market, and in property, seeing clearly is already an enormous advantage.

Let us begin.

CHAPTER ONE

The Same Project, Two Very Different Prices

Why This Happens More Than You Think

There is a question I find myself returning to often when I think about how most buyers approach the new launch market. It is not a complicated question, but it gets to the heart of something that most people have never had the chance to consider. The question is this: if you and a friend both bought a unit in the same new launch condominium, in the same development, with similar floor plans and orientations, is it possible that you paid two noticeably different prices? The answer, and I want to say this clearly, is yes. It happens regularly. And in many cases, the difference is not marginal.

When buyers visit a showflat, there is a natural tendency to treat the price list as a fixed and objective document. The figures are printed, the developer's representatives are professional, and the whole experience is designed to feel authoritative and final. But a price list for a new launch is not a static artefact. It is a document that reflects where the developer is in their sales cycle at the specific moment you are sitting in that showflat. The same project, in an

earlier phase, will have had a different price list. In many cases, that earlier price list was lower. Sometimes meaningfully so.

To understand why this happens, it helps to start with a simple observation about how developers approach the business of selling a new development. A developer who launches a project with several hundred units does not release all of those units to the market at once. That is not how it works. Instead, units are released in batches, with each batch priced according to where the project sits in its momentum curve. The very first batch, often called the preview or VVIP phase, is typically priced to generate energy and achieve strong early sales. Early bird discounts at this phase are documented and real, and they can run to approximately ten to eleven percent off the prices that the same unit type will carry once the development enters its public launch. After that initial phase, assuming sales are healthy, the developer revises the price list upward. This is not arbitrary. It is a deliberate strategy, and it serves the developer's financial interests in a very specific way.

Here is something most buyers do not know about the relationship between a developer and their bank. When a developer takes on financing to fund a new project, the bank does not simply hand over the full loan at once. The release of funds is typically tied to sales performance, with the developer needing to achieve a certain proportion of sales, broadly around thirty percent of units, early in the project to satisfy the bank's requirements and unlock subsequent tranches of financing. This creates a powerful and very practical incentive for the developer to price the first phase attractively. They need those early sales. They need the momentum. And once they have it, once that thirty percent threshold has been

crossed and the project is demonstrably moving, the calculus changes. The urgency to sell cheaply eases, and the price list reflects that shift.

What this means for a buyer who arrives at the showflat six months after a project's launch weekend is that they are, by definition, looking at a price list that has already moved. The developer has made their early sales, the bank is satisfied, and the remaining units are priced to reflect the project's established demand. That is not a problem with the market. It is simply how the market works. The issue is that most buyers do not know this history. They walk in, see the current price, and evaluate it against their budget and expectations, never knowing that an earlier buyer in the same block, on a comparable floor, paid a figure that looked quite different.

There is a third mechanism that creates pricing variation across a project's lifecycle, and it works in a direction that is perhaps less obvious. Under Singapore's ABSD remission rules for developers, a housing developer who acquires residential land is subject to substantial Additional Buyer's Stamp Duty, of which a significant portion is remittable provided the developer meets a strict condition: all units in the development must be sold within five years of the land acquisition date. This is not a soft guideline. It is a regulatory requirement with real financial consequences. A developer who approaches that five year mark with unsold inventory faces a meaningful financial penalty if they fail to clear those units in time. And developers, being rational commercial actors, respond to that pressure by becoming considerably more motivated to move their remaining stock. That motivation can and does manifest as pricing

adjustments, incentives, and a general willingness to engage that looks quite different from the posture a developer takes in the early months of a confident launch.

So we have three distinct points in a project's lifecycle where pricing dynamics shift in ways that a buyer who is paying attention can recognise and act on. There is the early preview phase, where discounts are at their highest and unit selection is at its widest. There is the mid cycle phase, where specific unit types that were withheld from earlier releases come onto the market for the first time, sometimes at pricing levels set before the later batches in the same project pushed the overall list higher. And there is the late cycle phase, where a developer's ABSD timeline is pressing and their appetite to deal has grown considerably. These are real, verifiable windows. They are not secret. But they are also not visible to someone who simply walks into a showflat when they happen to feel ready to buy.

I want to address something directly here, because I think it is important to be honest about it. Not every project follows this pattern in the same way. There are developments where pricing is compressed across phases, where the early bird discount and the later public launch price are almost identical. There are boutique projects of thirty or forty units that sell out so quickly that there is barely a distinction between phases at all. And there are projects where the unit types a buyer actually wants are not released until the second or third phase, which means an early buyer may secure a lower overall entry point but not necessarily on their preferred unit. The framework I am sharing is not a guarantee. It is a lens. And like any lens, it works best when you understand what you are looking at

and why.

What I can say with confidence, and what the data from Singapore's property market consistently bears out, is that buyers who enter a new launch in the first phase, or who are positioned to act when a developer's ABSD clock is running short, have historically paid less for comparable units than buyers who arrived in between those moments. The difference in loss rates between buyers in the earliest batches and those who purchased in the final ten percent of a project's sales has been documented in URA transaction data, and the pattern holds across market cycles and across regions of the island. Timing, in the context of new launches, is not a luxury consideration. It is a pricing variable. And a pricing variable, once you understand how to read it, becomes something you can work with rather than something that works against you.

The question that follows from all of this is an obvious one: if these pricing windows exist and are as meaningful as I am suggesting, why do most buyers miss them? The answer has several parts, and I will work through them carefully over the pages ahead. But the short version is this. Most buyers enter the market when they feel personally ready, not when the market is positioned to offer them advantage. They visit a showflat when a project has already been open for months. They compare prices across projects using the headline PSF figure without understanding what phase of the sales cycle each project is actually in. And they make their decisions based on what is visible and immediate rather than on an understanding of what the pricing structure beneath the surface actually looks like.

That is what the rest of this book is designed to change.

CHAPTER TWO

How Developers Actually Price a New Launch

The Three Mechanics Behind Every Price List

One of the things I have noticed over the years is that buyers tend to think about developer pricing the way they think about pricing at a supermarket. The number on the shelf is the number. It reflects some combination of cost and margin that the seller has decided on, and as a buyer, your job is simply to decide whether you are willing to pay it. That mental model is understandable, because it is how pricing works in most of the transactions we encounter in daily life. But it is exactly the wrong way to think about a new launch in Singapore, and holding onto it will cost you more than you realise.

Developer pricing for a new launch is not a fixed number arrived at before sales begin and held steady throughout the project's life. It is a living structure, one that is shaped by financial obligations, sales performance, market sentiment, and regulatory timelines, all of which shift as the project moves from its opening phase through to its final units. Understanding that structure is the foundation of everything else in this book, because once you see

how it is built, the pricing variation I described in the previous chapter stops seeming mysterious and starts seeming entirely logical.

Let me walk you through the three core mechanics that drive how a new launch is priced.

The first and most widely discussed is the phased release strategy. When a developer brings a new project to market, they do not release every unit on day one. A development of four hundred or six hundred units will typically come to market in a series of batches, each representing a portion of the total inventory. The first batch is released during what the industry calls the preview or VVIP phase, which takes place before the project's official public launch. This phase is invite only in principle, though in practice, any buyer who has registered interest through a developer appointed agent can generally access it. The purpose of the preview phase is to build momentum. The developer needs to generate early sales, create a sense of demand and desirability around the project, and signal to the broader market that the development is moving. To achieve this, they price the first batch attractively. Early bird discounts at the preview phase are a documented feature of the Singapore new launch market, and they typically run in the range of eight to eleven percent off what the same unit type will carry once the project enters its public launch period.

Once the preview phase closes and the project moves into its official launch, the early bird pricing is withdrawn. The developer revises the price list upward, and subsequent batches are released at these higher figures. As the project continues to sell and the take up rate builds, further price revisions follow. The pattern is broadly

consistent: each time a meaningful sales milestone is crossed, the developer reassesses the price list and adjusts accordingly. The psychology behind this is straightforward. A project that is visibly selling well justifies a higher price in the minds of both the developer and future buyers. Rising prices also protect the returns of early buyers, which matters to the developer's reputation and their ability to generate demand in future projects. A buyer who purchased in the first phase and then watches the price list climb above what they paid feels vindicated. That feeling is not accidental. It is engineered into the release structure.

What this means practically is that two buyers who purchase in the same development, one during the VVIP preview and one six months into the public launch, are paying prices from two different points on this curve. The project is identical. The developer is identical. The location, the facilities, the tenure and the floor plan are all the same. The only variable is where each buyer sat in the sales timeline, and that variable translates directly into a real money difference on their purchase price.

The second mechanic is less well known among buyers, but it is arguably more important for understanding why developers price the way they do in the first phase. It has to do with the relationship between a developer and their bank, and it shapes the incentive structure behind everything that happens in the early months of a launch.

When a developer acquires a site and secures financing to fund construction, the bank does not release the full loan in a single disbursement. The loan is structured in tranches, with each tranche tied to the achievement of specific milestones. One of the most

significant of those milestones is an early sales target, typically set at around thirty percent of the total units in the development. Until the developer achieves that threshold, access to subsequent portions of the loan facility is restricted. This creates a very direct and very practical pressure on the developer in the early stages of a launch. They are not simply hoping that early sales will come. They need them. The financing of the project depends on it.

This need for early volume is one of the strongest forces acting on developer pricing at the preview and launch phase. A developer who prices their first batch too aggressively, too far above what the market is willing to absorb quickly, risks missing that thirty percent target and creating a financing problem. That is a risk most developers are not willing to take, particularly in the current environment where construction costs are elevated and land prices have been competitive. So the first phase pricing reflects both the developer's long term margin ambitions and their short term financing obligations. They need to sell, and they need to sell relatively quickly, and the price is set with that reality in mind.

Once that thirty percent threshold is achieved and the bank is satisfied, the urgency changes. The developer has fulfilled their primary obligation to their lender. They are no longer selling out of necessity. They are selling for optimisation, and optimisation means maximising the return on the remaining units. That is when the price list gets revised upward, sometimes in a single step and sometimes in a series of smaller increments, and that is when the window that existed in the first phase closes behind the buyers who caught it.

The third mechanic is the one that most buyers know the least about, despite it being embedded in Singapore's regulatory

framework and publicly documented. It concerns the Additional Buyer's Stamp Duty obligations that apply specifically to housing developers, and the five year deadline that governs how long a developer has to sell all units in a development before those obligations crystallise into significant financial penalties.

When a developer acquires residential land in Singapore, they are subject to ABSD at a rate of forty percent of the land price. The bulk of this, thirty five percentage points, is remittable, meaning the developer can recover it, provided they meet a strict condition. Every single unit in the development must be sold within five years of the date of land acquisition. Not most units. Not ninety five percent. Every unit. If even a handful of units remain unsold when that five year window expires, the developer forfeits the remission and faces a substantial financial hit. On a large land purchase, the sum involved can be enormous.

What this creates, as a project moves through its third, fourth and fifth years of the sales cycle, is a very different kind of developer motivation than the one that existed at launch. In the early phase, the developer was managing momentum and optimising price. In the late phase, they are managing a deadline. A developer with fifty unsold units and eighteen months remaining on their ABSD clock is in a fundamentally different position than the same developer at the project's launch weekend. They have more to lose by holding firm on price than by making their remaining inventory attractive to the market. That shift in motivation creates pricing conditions for buyers that are genuinely different from what the public launch period offered, and they are available to buyers who know to look for them.

I want to be careful here, because it would be easy to overstate what this means in practice. Not every project approaches its ABSD deadline with large volumes of unsold stock. Many well located, well priced developments sell through cleanly long before the five year window becomes a concern. But there are always projects where sales have moved more slowly than the developer anticipated, where the unit mix or the market timing created a slower absorption rate, and where the ABSD clock is genuinely a factor in how the developer approaches pricing in the final stretch. For a buyer who is tracking the market carefully, these situations are not hidden. They are visible in URA transaction data, in the pace of sales across different projects, and in the behaviour of the developers involved.

Beyond these three primary mechanics, there is a fourth dimension to developer pricing that is worth understanding because it affects the effective price you pay even when the headline PSF looks consistent. That dimension is the pricing differential across floors within the same project. Higher floors in a development are generally more desirable, because they offer better views, more natural light, and a greater sense of separation from the street. Developers recognise this and price accordingly. A unit on the twenty fifth floor of a development will typically carry a higher PSF than an identical unit on the tenth floor, sometimes substantially so. This is standard practice across the market, and it means that two buyers purchasing the same floor plan in the same project can end up at quite different actual prices depending on where in the building their unit sits. The floor differential is not always communicated clearly in showflat conversations, and buyers who do not ask specifically about the pricing grid across floors can find themselves comparing their total quantum against a neighbour's

without fully understanding why the numbers look different.

There is also a dimension to phased releases that I touched on earlier but want to address more explicitly here, because it is one of the most common sources of confusion I encounter among buyers who have done some research but not quite enough. The assumption that the first phase of a new launch is automatically the best entry point is not always correct, and acting on that assumption without understanding the details of a specific project can lead buyers to make rushed decisions. The reason is simple: not all unit types are released in the first phase. A developer may choose to hold back their larger three and four bedroom units, or their premium stacks, until a later phase when the project has established its market positioning and the developer has greater confidence in where those units can be priced. A buyer who rushes to enter at the preview phase may secure a one or two bedroom unit at an attractive early bird price, but the three bedroom they actually wanted may not appear on the price list for another six months, and when it does, it may be priced at a level that reflects the project's more established phase rather than its opening one.

This is why the framework I am sharing in this book is not a simple instruction to buy early. It is a more complete picture of how the system works, so that you can evaluate where a specific project sits in its cycle and what that means for the unit type you are actually looking for. The mechanics I have described here are consistent across the market. The application of those mechanics to any given project requires a more detailed look at that project's specific situation: its total unit count, its current sales pace, how much of the inventory has been released versus held back, where it

sits relative to its ABSD timeline, and how its pricing compares to the comparable benchmarks in its district and region.

That more detailed evaluation is something I will walk through step by step in the later part of this book. But before we get to the application of the framework, there is something important to address: the specific windows within a project's lifecycle where the mechanics I have described here create genuine entry advantages. Because knowing that the windows exist is not the same as knowing how to find them.

CHAPTER THREE

The Three Windows

Where the Real Entry Advantage Exists in a Project's Lifecycle

If there is one thing I want you to take away from everything written so far, it is this: pricing in a new launch is not a snapshot. It is a story that unfolds over time, shaped by the mechanics I described in the previous chapter, and at different points in that story, the conditions facing a buyer are genuinely different. Not slightly different. Not different in ways that require a financial expert to detect. Different in ways that show up as real numbers on a real price list, representing real money that a buyer either captures or does not, depending entirely on whether they understood the story well enough to know where they were standing in it.

I call these points the three windows. Each one represents a distinct phase in a project's lifecycle where pricing conditions shift in a buyer's favour, for reasons that are structural rather than coincidental. None of them requires a buyer to do anything unusual or to have access to anything that is unavailable to the general public. What they require is an understanding of when these moments occur, what causes them, and how to recognise them in a

specific project rather than as an abstract concept.

Let me take you through each one.

The first window is the preview phase, and it is the one that most people in the industry have at least some awareness of, even if they do not fully understand how to access it or what it actually offers. Before a new launch opens its doors to the public, before the launch weekend that gets covered in property news and discussed in forums and group chats, there is an earlier phase in which the developer releases a portion of their units to a select group of buyers. This phase goes by several names. You will hear it called the VVIP preview, the soft launch, or simply the preview, and while the terminology varies, the substance is consistent. The developer is releasing early inventory at pricing designed to generate momentum, and buyers who are in the room during this phase are accessing a price list that will not exist once the public launch begins.

The early bird discount at this phase is a documented feature of the Singapore new launch market. It is not a rumour or a sales tactic used to manufacture urgency. Developers genuinely price their preview inventory more attractively than their subsequent phases, and the difference historically runs to somewhere between eight and eleven percent off the public launch price for comparable units. On a property priced at one and a half million dollars, that range represents between one hundred and twenty thousand and one hundred and sixty five thousand dollars. On a two million dollar unit, the figures are higher still. That is not an insignificant sum, and it is available to buyers who are positioned to act during the preview window rather than waiting for the public launch.

There is something worth understanding about how the preview phase works in practice, because there is a persistent misconception that it is truly exclusive, that only celebrities, major investors or people with deep personal connections to the developer can access it. That was perhaps more true in an earlier era of the market. Today, the reality is more straightforward. The preview is accessible to buyers who have registered their interest through one of the developer appointed marketing agencies before the project opens to the public. A registered buyer who has submitted their details, indicated their unit preferences, and been briefed on the project by their agent can typically attend the preview and make a booking before the general public has any opportunity to do so. The key is knowing that the preview exists and having an agent who is plugged into the right network to get you registered in time.

What the preview phase offers beyond price is something that buyers often undervalue until they have experienced a popular launch. It offers choice. When a well priced project in a good location opens to the general public on launch weekend, the most desirable units move very quickly. Preferred stacks, higher floors, corner units with better orientation, the layouts that a large number of buyers are competing for tend to be spoken for within hours. A buyer who enters during the preview phase has first access to the inventory that has been released in that batch. They are not competing with a crowd. They are selecting from a fuller menu before that menu is trimmed by the choices of others. For many buyers, the peace of mind that comes with this, the ability to look at the options available to them without time pressure and make a considered decision, is worth as much as the financial advantage.

I do want to address a nuance here that I think is important for buyers to understand, because a framework is only useful when it is honest about its limitations. The preview phase is not always the cheapest entry point for every unit type in a project. Developers make choices about which units to release in which phase, and those choices are strategic. The first batch released at preview pricing may consist primarily of one bedroom and two bedroom units, or of a particular stack or facing that the developer is confident will move quickly. The three bedroom units that a family sized buyer actually wants, or the higher floor units with the unobstructed view, may be held back for a subsequent phase. When they are released, they will carry the pricing of that later phase rather than the preview pricing. This means that the preview advantage is real, but it applies most cleanly to buyers whose preferred unit type is included in the first batch release. For buyers with specific requirements, the preview is still the right moment to engage, because even if the exact unit they want is not yet available, being registered and present at the preview gives them priority access and relationship with the developer's team that carries into subsequent releases.

The second window is less widely discussed, and I think that is precisely why it represents such a genuine opportunity for buyers who understand it. It occurs in the middle of a project's sales cycle, typically after the initial launch momentum has settled and before the final phase becomes urgent, and it is created by a very specific feature of how developers manage their inventory releases over time.

Not all units in a new launch are released to the market at once. Even beyond the distinction between the preview phase and the

public launch, developers continue to release units in batches throughout the sales cycle of the project. A portion of the inventory is always held back. Sometimes this is because the developer wants to maintain pricing discipline and not flood the market with too much choice at once, which can paradoxically reduce the urgency buyers feel and slow sales. Sometimes it is because specific unit types, the larger family units, the penthouse levels, the premium facing stacks, are being held for a strategic moment in the project's trajectory when the developer believes the market will support a higher price for them.

What this creates, and this is the mechanism that produces the second window, is a situation where units that are appearing on the price list for the first time are doing so at a pricing level set relative to where the project was when that batch was allocated, rather than necessarily at the highest point the overall project has reached. In a project that has been selling steadily and revising prices upward across multiple phases, a batch of units released mid cycle may carry a price that, while higher than the preview phase, is noticeably lower than the most recently sold units in the same development. The buyer who enters during this mid cycle release is not getting the cheapest possible entry point, but they may be getting a better one than a buyer who entered the project three months earlier at a higher priced batch, and they may be getting it on the specific unit type that actually fits their needs.

Identifying this window requires a more active approach to the market than most buyers take. It requires knowing which projects have inventory that has not yet been released, understanding the pacing of releases across different developments, and being ready to

act when a new batch comes to market rather than waiting to be prompted by advertising. An agent who is closely tracking the pipeline across multiple projects can flag these moments before they become visible to the general market, and that early visibility is often the difference between accessing the batch before the most desirable units in it are taken and arriving to find that the options remaining are the least appealing ones.

The third window is the one that is most driven by external pressure rather than developer strategy, and in some ways it is the most powerful of the three because the developer's motivation to move units is at its highest. It is the late cycle window, created by the approach of the five year ABSD sale deadline that I explained in the previous chapter.

As a project enters the final eighteen months to two years of its ABSD timeline with meaningful unsold inventory still on the books, the developer's position changes fundamentally. In the early phases of the project, the developer was in control of the conversation. They could afford to hold firm on pricing, manage their releases carefully, and let demand come to them. In the late cycle, with a regulatory clock running and a financial penalty of real magnitude waiting at the end of the road, the developer becomes considerably more motivated to engage. That motivation does not always manifest as dramatic discounts or fire sale announcements. Developers are careful about how they manage their price lists, because a visible drop in pricing can damage the resale values of buyers who purchased earlier in the project and create the kind of negative sentiment that makes the remaining units even harder to shift. Instead, the adjustments tend to be more targeted: selective

incentives on specific unit types, more flexible payment arrangements, a willingness to negotiate on certain finishes or fittings, or the release of previously withheld units at pricing that is strategically set to clear the remaining inventory.

For a buyer who is tracking the market carefully, these late cycle situations are identifiable. URA transaction data is publicly available and shows the pace of sales across all new launch projects, making it possible to identify developments where absorption has been slower than expected and where the ABSD timeline is becoming a consideration. A project that launched four years ago and still has twenty percent of its units unsold is in a different pricing conversation than the same project at the one year mark. The developer's motivation is different. Their appetite for a straightforward transaction at a fair price is higher. And a buyer who comes to that conversation informed, knowing what the developer's situation looks like, is in a meaningfully stronger position than one who arrives unaware of any of this.

I want to be precise about something here, because I think an honest framework serves buyers better than an optimistic one. The late cycle window is not a guarantee of discount. There are projects where developers hold firmly to their price list right through to the ABSD deadline, accepting the financial penalty rather than selling below their stated price. There are also situations where the market around a slower selling project improves in the late cycle, giving the developer renewed confidence and reducing their urgency. The late cycle window is a real phenomenon with documented examples, but it is not a universal rule. It is a possibility that exists in specific projects under specific conditions, and identifying those conditions

accurately is part of what the framework in this book is designed to help you do.

What ties all three windows together is a principle that I think is worth stating plainly, because it runs counter to how most buyers approach the market. The best time to engage with a new launch project is almost never the moment you happen to feel personally ready. Life works that way. Buying decisions are tied to personal circumstances, to when an HDB flat reaches its Minimum Occupation Period, to when a couple gets married, to when a lease expires or a family grows beyond its current space. I understand that. But if there is any flexibility at all in your timeline, aligning your entry point with one of the three windows I have described here, rather than simply acting when it is convenient, can make a substantial difference to what you ultimately pay.

The buyers who capture the preview phase advantage are not, in my experience, particularly sophisticated investors or people with unusual market knowledge. They are simply people who decided to understand the system before entering it, who registered their interest before a project launched rather than after, and who had an agent who knew how to get them into the room at the right moment. The buyers who benefit from the mid cycle window are people who stayed engaged with the market between launches rather than going dormant until they felt urgency again. And the buyers who find genuine opportunity in the late cycle window are people who were paying attention to which projects were running behind on sales, rather than only looking at the newest and most heavily advertised launches.

None of this is complicated once you know what to look for. But knowing what to look for requires first understanding why the windows exist in the way they do. That is what the first two chapters of this book were building toward, and it is the foundation on which everything that follows is built. Because knowing that the windows exist is only the beginning. The next question, and it is one I hear constantly from buyers who have started to understand the pricing structure, is this: if the opportunity is there, why do so many buyers still end up paying more than they need to? The answer lies in a set of very specific comparison habits that are almost universal among new launch buyers, and understanding them is what separates a buyer who uses this framework effectively from one who knows the theory but still makes the expensive mistakes.

CHAPTER FOUR

Why Most Buyers Pay More Than They Need To

The Five Comparison Traps

There is a pattern I have watched play out so many times across so many showflat visits that I could describe it almost choreographically. A buyer arrives having done what feels like thorough research. They have looked at multiple projects online. They have compared prices. They have read the property news, spoken to friends who have recently bought, and perhaps attended one or two showflats before this one. They feel informed. They feel ready. And in most respects, they are genuinely engaged and serious about making a good decision. But somewhere in the research process, without knowing it, they have absorbed a set of comparison habits that are going to cost them money. Not because they are careless or unintelligent. But because the habits themselves are so widely shared and so rarely questioned that most buyers never think to examine them at all.

I call these the five comparison traps, and in my experience working with buyers across Singapore's private property market,

virtually every buyer falls into at least two or three of them. Some fall into all five. The traps are not obvious, which is precisely what makes them traps. Each one is built on a form of reasoning that is logical on its surface but breaks down when you understand the mechanics of how new launches actually work. Working through them one by one is important, because recognising a trap is the only way to stop walking into it.

The first trap is one that almost every buyer relies on as their primary comparison tool, and it is the per square foot figure. PSF is the lingua franca of the Singapore property market. It is how developments are compared in news articles, how agents describe pricing in conversations, and how buyers evaluate whether a project seems expensive or reasonable relative to its peers. The appeal of PSF as a metric is obvious: it strips out the effect of unit size and gives you a number that appears to allow apples to apples comparison across different properties. If Project A is selling at two thousand dollars per square foot and Project B is selling at two thousand two hundred dollars per square foot, Project A seems cheaper. That conclusion is intuitive and immediate. It is also frequently wrong, and the reason it is wrong is one of the most important things a buyer can understand about how the new launch market works.

PSF is a useful starting point, but it is an incomplete measure on its own, and treating it as the primary basis for comparison leads buyers to overlook variables that can reverse the apparent conclusion entirely. The first of those variables is the unit size itself. A one bedroom unit of four hundred and fifty square feet priced at two thousand two hundred PSF has a total quantum of just under

one million dollars. A two bedroom unit of seven hundred square feet priced at two thousand PSF has a total quantum of one million four hundred thousand dollars. Comparing the PSF figures tells you nothing useful about which represents better value, because the two buyers are not buying the same thing. The family that needs the two bedroom unit cannot substitute the one bedroom unit regardless of how attractive its PSF looks, and comparing them as if they are equivalent choices creates a distorted picture of the decision being made.

There is a second dimension to the PSF trap that is specific to new launches and less commonly discussed. When a developer releases units in phases, different unit types within the same project may carry very different PSF figures, not because the developer is being inconsistent, but because larger units typically carry a lower PSF than smaller units in the same development. The four bedroom unit may have a lower PSF than the one bedroom unit in the project next door, but a vastly higher total quantum. A buyer who filters projects by PSF alone will rank these options in a way that does not reflect the actual cost of acquiring the unit they need. The discipline of always converting PSF back to total quantum before making any comparison is one of the simplest and most valuable habits a new launch buyer can develop.

The second trap is the static price list assumption, and it follows directly from the mechanics described in the earlier chapters of this book. When a buyer visits a showflat and picks up a price list, there is an almost universal tendency to treat that document as if it represents the definitive and fixed pricing of the development. The figures are printed. The developer's team refers to them with

authority. The whole environment of a professional showflat encourages the impression of finality. But a price list for a new launch is a snapshot of where pricing sits at a particular point in the project's sales cycle, and that snapshot is almost certainly different from where pricing was at an earlier point in the same project's life.

What the static price list assumption leads buyers to do is evaluate a project only on the basis of what is available to them right now, rather than understanding what the pricing trajectory of the project has looked like over time. A buyer who visits a project six months after its launch and sees units priced at two thousand two hundred PSF has no automatic awareness that the same project opened at a VVIP preview price closer to two thousand PSF. They see the current list, evaluate it against their budget and expectations, and make a decision based on incomplete information. The project may still represent good value at its current pricing. But the buyer has no way to know that without understanding where it started, how fast it has moved, and what that pace says about the developer's confidence and the market's absorption of the inventory. An agent who tracks a project from before its launch through its sales cycle has this information. A buyer who arrives at the showflat cold does not, and the difference between those two positions is not trivial.

The third trap is what I think of as the showflat effect, and it is so well engineered by developers and their interior design teams that even buyers who know about it intellectually still find themselves affected by it. A showflat is not a neutral presentation of what you are buying. It is a carefully constructed experience designed to create a specific emotional response, and that response is the feeling that the space is generous, beautiful, liveable and worth the price

being asked. Developers invest significantly in their showflats precisely because they know how powerful that emotional impression is in shaping the decisions buyers make.

The showflat effect operates through several mechanisms. The show unit is typically furnished to a standard that is considerably higher than the developer's actual specifications, with premium materials, custom cabinetry and high end appliances that may not be included in the actual purchase. The ceiling height in a show unit is often higher than the standard across the rest of the development, because ceiling height is one of the most powerful determinants of how spacious a space feels. Certain walls may be removed or reconfigured to open up the layout, giving a sense of flow and volume that does not reflect how the unit actually sits in the building. Scent, lighting and carefully chosen furniture scale all work together to make the space feel more comfortable than a neutral viewing would suggest. None of this is dishonest in a legal sense. But it does mean that the impression formed during a showflat visit is systematically biased in the developer's favour, and a buyer who does not consciously correct for that bias is making their decision on the basis of a distorted picture.

The practical correction is simple but requires discipline. Always ask specifically about the ceiling height of the actual unit you are considering, and whether it matches the show unit. Ask which appliances and fittings are included in the purchase price and which are display only. Ask to see the floor plan of the specific unit you are looking at on paper, not just as rendered in the show unit, so that you can evaluate the layout against your actual furniture and living habits rather than against someone else's carefully arranged

props. And if at all possible, visit the site itself to understand the actual orientation, the surrounding environment, and the views that will be available from the floor and stack you are considering, rather than relying entirely on the artist's impression mounted on the showflat wall.

The fourth trap is one that developers and their marketing teams know how to exploit very effectively, and it is the percentage sold signal. In the weeks and months following a new launch, you will frequently encounter claims that a project is eighty percent sold, or that a certain number of units were taken up on the launch weekend. These figures are presented as evidence of demand and are used to create a sense of urgency in buyers who have not yet committed. The implication is that if you do not act quickly, you will miss out on a successful development that others have already validated with their own money. That implication can be genuinely useful information, or it can be almost entirely misleading, depending on something that the headline figure never tells you: how many units were actually released.

A developer who releases one hundred and twenty units during the preview phase and sells ninety of them on the launch weekend can accurately claim that seventy five percent of available units were sold. If the total development contains six hundred units, however, that represents fifteen percent of the overall inventory. The development is far from sold out. The remaining eighty percent of units, including many of the unit types and stacks that were not part of the initial release, are still very much available. But the percentage sold headline creates an impression of scarcity and momentum that may not accurately reflect the real supply situation

for the specific unit a buyer is looking for. Developers are under no obligation to clarify how many total units are in the development relative to how many have been released, and most buyers do not think to ask. The result is that urgency is manufactured where it may not genuinely exist, and buyers make rushed decisions based on a signal that has been deliberately framed to be as compelling as possible.

The fifth trap is perhaps the most expensive in practical terms, and it is the one that most directly connects to the framework I have been building throughout this book. It is the habit of engaging with a project only after the public launch rather than before it. Most buyers begin their serious evaluation of a new launch once the project is already open to the public, because that is when it becomes visible. The advertising begins. The news coverage appears. Friends start talking about it. The showflat opens its doors. For a buyer who has been waiting passively for the right moment to enter the market, this visibility is the signal that the time has come to act.

But by the time that signal arrives, the most advantageous moment in the project's pricing cycle has already passed. The preview phase, where early bird pricing was available and unit selection was at its fullest, happened before the public launch. The buyers who accessed that phase did so because they were already registered and engaged before the project reached the point of mass visibility. The buyer who begins their evaluation at the public launch is already looking at a revised price list, choosing from a depleted unit selection, and competing with a much larger pool of interested buyers. They are, in structural terms, starting the race at

the three hundred metre mark.

The correction for this trap requires a change in how buyers think about their relationship with the market. Instead of waiting for a project to become publicly visible before engaging with it, the buyer who wants to access preview pricing needs to be engaged before that point. This means registering interest in upcoming launches before they open, maintaining a relationship with an agent who is positioned within the developer marketing networks and can flag preview dates, and being financially and mentally prepared to make a decision during the preview window rather than after weeks of further deliberation. It does not mean rushing into a purchase that does not fit your circumstances. It means arranging your readiness in advance so that when a window opens, you are positioned to evaluate it clearly and act on it if it is the right opportunity.

What runs through all five of these traps is a common thread: they are all products of reactive engagement with the market rather than proactive engagement. The buyer who compares only on PSF is reacting to the most visible and easily available number. The buyer who accepts the price list as static is reacting to what is in front of them without asking what came before. The buyer who is swayed by the showflat experience is reacting to a carefully engineered environment without questioning what it is actually showing them. The buyer who interprets percentage sold figures at face value is reacting to marketing framing without interrogating the underlying data. And the buyer who starts engaging after the public launch is reacting to visibility rather than positioning themselves ahead of it.

The alternative to reactive engagement is not complicated, and it is not something that requires unusual expertise or resources. It is simply a matter of understanding how the market works well enough to engage with it on your own terms rather than on the terms that developers and their marketing machines have set. A buyer who understands the five traps can walk into a showflat and evaluate it with clear eyes. They know what the PSF figure tells them and what it does not. They know to ask when the project launched, what the preview pricing looked like, and how the current price list compares to where the project started. They know that the showflat is a commercial environment rather than a neutral one, and they examine the actual unit specifications separately. They know how to read a percentage sold claim in the context of total inventory rather than in isolation. And they know that if they are standing in the showflat during the public launch period, the best window has already passed for this project, which means their energy should be directed toward identifying the next one before it opens rather than making a rushed decision on the current one.

That combination of awareness is what transforms a buyer from someone the market happens to into someone who engages with the market deliberately. And in the Singapore new launch environment, where the difference between an early phase entry and a late phase entry on the same project can represent a sum that takes years to recover, that transformation is worth more than almost any other piece of preparation a buyer can do before they start making serious decisions.

There is one more thing I want to say here before moving into the final part of this book, where I bring everything together into a

practical decision process. The five traps I have described are not the result of buyers being gullible or uninformed in any fundamental sense. They are the result of buyers using mental models that work perfectly well in most purchasing contexts but that simply do not fit the specific mechanics of the new launch market. The buyer who evaluates a new launch the same way they would evaluate a resale unit, or the same way they would buy a car, is not making an irrational error. They are making a category error. They are applying the right tools to the wrong problem.

Once you see the new launch market clearly, through the lens of the mechanics and the windows and the comparison habits we have worked through across these pages, the decisions that follow become considerably more straightforward. Not easy, because property is never entirely simple, and every buyer's circumstances are specific to them. But straightforward in the sense that the questions you need to ask become clearer, the information you need to gather becomes more defined, and the framework for making a good decision becomes something you can actually hold in your hands and use.

That framework, applied step by step to the actual decisions a buyer faces in 2026, is what the final chapter is about.

CHAPTER FIVE

How to Apply the Framework in 2026

A Step by Step Decision Process

Everything covered in the previous chapters has been building toward a single practical outcome: giving you a way to engage with the Singapore new launch market that is grounded in how it actually works, rather than how it appears to work from the outside. The mechanics of developer pricing, the three windows of genuine entry advantage, and the five comparison traps that erode the decisions of otherwise careful buyers, all of these pieces come together into a framework that changes how you evaluate a project, what questions you ask, and ultimately what you pay. In this final chapter, I want to bring that framework to ground level. Not as theory, but as a sequence of concrete steps that you can apply to any new launch you are seriously considering in today's market.

Before I walk through the steps, I want to set the context honestly, because I think it matters for how you interpret everything that follows. The Singapore private property market in 2025 and 2026 is not a buyer's market in the traditional sense of that phrase.

Prices are not falling. Developers are not desperate. The overall trajectory of new launch pricing across all three regions remains upward, supported by elevated land costs, construction cost pressures, genuine HDB upgrader demand, and a regulatory framework that is specifically designed to prevent the kind of speculative volatility that might create widespread bargain opportunities. If you are approaching the market hoping to find a development where prices have collapsed and deals are waiting to be snapped up, this framework is not going to produce that outcome, because that market does not exist in Singapore in any meaningful way right now.

What the framework offers instead is something more precise and arguably more valuable: a measurable entry advantage within a rising market. In the Outside Central Region, new launch pricing in 2026 broadly sits in the range of one thousand eight hundred to two thousand three hundred dollars per square foot. In the Rest of Central Region, that range moves to approximately two thousand four hundred to two thousand eight hundred dollars per square foot. In the Core Central Region, pricing begins at around two thousand eight hundred dollars per square foot and extends considerably higher for premium developments. These are not soft or speculative figures. They reflect what buyers are actually paying in the current market, and they are the baseline against which any entry advantage you achieve needs to be understood.

Within that baseline, the difference between a buyer who enters a project during the VVIP preview at early bird pricing and a buyer who enters the same project six months later at the revised public launch price is typically somewhere between eight and eleven

percent of the total purchase price. For a unit priced at one and a half million dollars, that range represents between one hundred and twenty thousand and one hundred and sixty five thousand dollars. For a two million dollar unit, the figures are proportionally higher. These are not theoretical savings. They are the documented difference between two price lists for the same product in the same development, and they are available to buyers who are positioned to access the preview window rather than the public launch. When you add the potential of a late cycle ABSD motivated situation on top of that, the total pricing advantage a well informed buyer can capture over a buyer who approaches the market reactively is substantial.

With that context established, let me take you through the five steps of the framework as I apply it when working with buyers in today's market.

The first step is to get into the pipeline before projects go public. This sounds straightforward but it requires a meaningful shift in how most buyers think about their relationship with the market. The average buyer begins paying serious attention to a new launch when they see it advertised, when a friend mentions it, or when the showflat opens and the project enters mainstream visibility. By that point, as I explained in the previous chapter, the preview window has already closed. The first step of the framework is therefore not about evaluating a specific project. It is about positioning yourself to be aware of what is coming before it arrives.

In practical terms, this means registering your interest across the upcoming pipeline of launches that are relevant to your budget, preferred region, and unit type requirements. It means maintaining an active relationship with an agent who is connected to the

developer marketing networks and who will flag preview dates, indicative pricing ranges, and floor plan releases before those details become publicly available. The Singapore new launch pipeline is not secret. Developers acquire land through the Government Land Sales programme, and GLS results are publicly announced. A developer who wins a site in a specific district will typically bring that project to market within a defined timeframe, and the trajectory from land acquisition to launch preview is broadly predictable for those who are watching it. Being in the pipeline means knowing what is coming, knowing roughly when it is expected to launch, and being ready to evaluate it when the preview invitation arrives rather than after the launch weekend has passed.

The second step is to evaluate the project against its land cost and regional benchmarks before you evaluate it against your personal preferences. This is a step that most buyers skip entirely, and it is one of the most powerful tools available for understanding whether a project's pricing represents genuine value or whether you are being asked to pay a premium that the underlying economics do not fully support.

Every new launch in Singapore can be understood through the relationship between the developer's land cost and their expected selling price. The land cost is a matter of public record, disclosed through the GLS tender results that are announced by the relevant government agencies. From the land cost, an informed buyer or their agent can derive a broad estimate of the developer's breakeven price, which then sets the floor below which the project is unlikely to be priced and the range within which a commercially rational developer needs to sell in order to achieve a viable margin. When

you then compare the project's actual launch pricing against comparable developments in the same district, using URA's publicly available transaction data as your reference point, you get a picture of where the project sits relative to the established market. A project priced at a meaningful premium to its immediate comparables needs a compelling reason for that premium, whether it is a significantly better location, a superior product specification, or a scarcity story that genuinely holds up to scrutiny. A project priced in line with or slightly below its comparables is signalling something different, and understanding which situation you are looking at changes how you should think about timing your entry.

This step is also where the three windows I described in the earlier chapter become most useful as an evaluative tool. A project with a strong land cost story, priced competitively against its regional benchmarks and in the early phase of its sales cycle, represents a very different opportunity from a project that is priced at the upper end of its comparable range and already a year into its launch with the preview phase well behind it. The framework is not about finding the cheapest project. It is about finding the best combination of project fundamentals and pricing cycle position, and that combination is only visible once you are looking at both dimensions simultaneously.

The third step is to assess the project's phase position and its remaining ABSD timeline. Once you have established that a project's fundamentals are sound and its pricing is reasonable relative to its land cost and regional benchmarks, the next question is where it sits in its own sales cycle and what that means for your entry point.

There are several pieces of information that answer this question. The first is the project's launch date, which tells you how much time has elapsed since the preview phase and how much of the ABSD window remains. A project that launched eighteen months ago has already closed its preview pricing advantage, but depending on its sales pace and unit count, it may or may not be approaching a late cycle dynamic. The second is the current sales rate, which you can track through URA's transaction data to understand how quickly units are moving and whether the project is ahead of, in line with, or behind the pace required to fully sell through before the ABSD deadline. The third is how much inventory remains and whether the units that are still available match the type you are actually looking for.

A project with three hundred units remaining, two and a half years on its ABSD clock, and a monthly sales rate of fifteen units is not in a comfortable position for its developer. A project with fifty units remaining, four years elapsed, and a monthly sales rate of eight units is in an acutely different position. Both situations represent something materially different from a project in its preview phase or its first months of public launch, and both call for a different strategy from the buyer. The discipline of checking this information before engaging with a project, rather than after you have already formed an emotional attachment to it in the showflat, is what allows you to walk into any sales conversation with a clear understanding of the developer's actual position.

The fourth step is to evaluate the specific unit you are considering at the level of its stack, floor, and orientation before committing to a number. This sounds like it should be obvious, but

the way most buyers approach a showflat makes it easy to overlook. A buyer who falls in love with the feel of the show unit and then books the first available unit of that type without carefully examining the specifics of the actual unit's position in the building is potentially paying for something quite different from what the showflat suggested.

Stack and floor position affect your actual experience of the unit in ways that do not show up in the PSF figure. A north facing unit in Singapore receives less direct afternoon sun than a west facing one, which has implications for comfort, air conditioning costs, and the long term condition of your finishes and furniture. A unit on the third floor above a road is a different living environment from the same unit type on the fifteenth floor above a park. A corner unit with windows on two sides has a very different quality of natural light from a mid block unit sandwiched between its neighbours. These are not minor considerations. They are the everyday reality of living in the space, and they affect both your experience as an owner occupier and the unit's appeal to future buyers or tenants if you ever choose to sell or lease.

The floor level also has a direct bearing on your actual purchase price, since developers price across floors with higher levels typically carrying a higher PSF. Understanding exactly where on the pricing grid your preferred unit sits, and whether the premium being charged for a higher floor is proportionate to the actual improvement in outlook and liveability, is part of making an informed decision. Sometimes the jump in price between one floor band and the next is modest relative to the improvement in the unit's position. Sometimes it is not, and a buyer who takes a slightly lower

floor in the same stack ends up with a meaningfully better quantum for a difference that is barely perceptible in practice.

The fifth step is to calculate your full financial picture across the progressive payment schedule before you commit to anything. New launch buyers in Singapore purchase under the Progressive Payment Scheme, which means the total purchase price is not paid upfront but in instalments tied to construction milestones. The initial booking fee is typically five to ten percent of the purchase price. Subsequent payments follow as the project achieves defined stages of construction, from foundation works through to structural completion, brick laying, roofing, and eventually the issuance of the Temporary Occupation Permit. The final payment, which represents the largest single tranche, falls due at or around TOP.

For a buyer who is upgrading from an HDB flat, the timing of these payments interacts with their existing financial situation in ways that need to be mapped out carefully before a commitment is made. If you still own an HDB at the time of purchasing a new launch, you will need to account for the Additional Buyer's Stamp Duty that applies to the new purchase, subject to any remission you may be eligible for if you sell the HDB within six months of the new property's TOP. The Total Debt Servicing Ratio rules, which cap the proportion of your gross monthly income that can go toward debt repayment, will affect how much of the purchase you can finance through a bank loan. The Loan to Value limits that apply to your specific situation, depending on how many outstanding mortgages you hold, determine the maximum financing available to you and therefore the cash or CPF you need to have ready at each payment milestone.

None of this is complicated when you work through it systematically, but the buyers who find themselves in financial difficulty with a new launch purchase are almost always buyers who did not map out the full progressive payment schedule against their actual cash flow and CPF position before they signed the Option to Purchase. A purchase that looks affordable at the booking fee stage can create significant stress if the milestone payments fall at a time when cash reserves are lower than anticipated, or if the construction timeline is extended beyond the initial estimate. Working through these numbers carefully before you commit, with a clear picture of what is due at each stage and how you will fund it, is not pessimism. It is the financial discipline that allows you to buy with confidence rather than anxiety.

Once these five steps have been completed, you are in a position that very few buyers ever reach before they make a new launch decision. You know what is coming in the pipeline before it goes public. You have evaluated the project's land cost and regional pricing context before you fell in love with the showflat. You understand where the project sits in its sales cycle and what that means for the pricing window available to you. You have examined the specific unit you are considering at the level of its actual position in the building rather than as an abstraction on a floor plan. And you have mapped your full financial commitment across the construction timeline against your real capacity to fund it at each stage. That combination of preparation does not remove uncertainty from the process, because property always involves some degree of uncertainty. But it removes the specific, avoidable, and expensive uncertainties that come from engaging with the market reactively rather than deliberately.

I want to close with something that I think often gets lost in conversations about property frameworks and market strategies, because those conversations tend to become abstract in a way that loses sight of what is actually at stake for the person making the decision. Buying a private property in Singapore is one of the most significant financial commitments most people will make in their lives. For many buyers, particularly those upgrading from an HDB flat, it represents the culmination of years of saving, planning and working toward a specific vision of what their home and their financial future should look like. The decision deserves to be made with clear eyes and accurate information, not with the distorted picture that comes from comparing PSF figures in isolation, or from arriving at a showflat after the best window has already passed, or from making a rushed call on a launch weekend because the percentage sold sign outside suggested there was no time to think.

The framework in this book is not designed to make property buying complicated. It is designed to make it clearer. The mechanics of how developers price their projects, the three windows where genuine entry advantage exists, and the five comparison habits that erode the decisions of otherwise well prepared buyers are not obscure or technical. They are the natural result of understanding a market well enough to see it for what it actually is rather than for what its marketing materials suggest. And once you see it clearly, the decisions that follow tend to be considerably better ones.

If you have read this far and you are now thinking about a specific project, a particular district, or a budget range and unit type that fits your situation, I would genuinely encourage you to reach out. Not because the next step requires my involvement, but because

applying a framework to a real and specific situation is always more useful than applying it in the abstract. Every buyer's circumstances are different. Every project has its own phase position, its own land cost story, its own ABSD timeline, and its own unit release pattern. The principles I have shared across these pages are consistent. The application of those principles to your specific decision is where the real work happens, and that is a conversation I am always glad to have.

The market in 2026 is active, well supplied with upcoming launches across all three regions, and full of buyers who are making decisions with varying degrees of preparation and understanding. The difference between the buyer who reads this book and the one who does not is not access to secret information. It is simply the clarity that comes from understanding the system before you enter it. That clarity, in a market where the entry price you pay today is the foundation on which all future returns are built, is worth more than almost anything else you can bring to the table.

Take your time. Ask the right questions. Know which window you are standing in. And when you are ready to take the next step, make sure you are taking it with the full picture in view.

About the Author

Darren Khew is a seasoned real estate agent specialising in Singapore's private residential market. He works with buyers at every stage of the property journey, from first time private property purchases to portfolio strategy, with a particular focus on new launch acquisitions and helping clients navigate the market with clarity and confidence.
